

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Offer choice -> Remove pressure to agree -> Genuine — not performative

START HERE

Before the next time you ask for something, explicitly give the person permission to say no or choose differently. Mean it.

SAY THIS

Autonomy Phrases	<i>"No pressure — only if it works for you."</i>
Remove Pressure	<i>"You do not have to decide now."</i>
Delegation Releases	<i>"You own this decision — I am here as a sounding board if you want one."</i>
Preference Plus Release	<i>"My preference is option A. The decision is still yours."</i>
Quick Releases	<i>"Totally your call."</i>

AVOID

- In situations requiring a directive decision — releasing autonomy when a clear call is needed causes confusion.
- When the other person genuinely wants and needs your recommendation rather than options.
- In emergency or safety situations where autonomy is not operationally appropriate.

REMEMBER

The release is priced at the first no.